Clair Smith

FRONTEND ENGINEER · ACCESSIBILITY & PERFORMANCE SPECIALIST

Austin, TX

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Frontend Developer with 12+ years of experience building scalable, accessible web applications across agency, consulting, and freelance environments. Specialized in accessibility engineering (AQA testing, WCAG compliance) and web performance — including founding a Core Web Vitals initiative now embedded in multiple client contracts. Proven track record architecting component libraries, leading technical teams, and translating complex UI/UX designs into performant, production-ready code across portfolios of up to 65 clients.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	JavaScript (ES5/ES6) TypeScript HTML5 SASS / SCSS
Frameworks	React Next.js Node.js Gatsby GraphQL REST APIs Twig
Build Tools	Webpack Vite NPM
Platforms	Drupal WordPress Storybook Lando DDEV Docker
AI Tools	Claude CLI GitHub Copilot Chat GPT
Design Tools	Figma InVision Sketch Photoshop Illustrator
Practices	Accessibility / AQA Testing WCAG 2.1 / 2.2 ARIA Core Web Vitals Atomic Design Information Architecture Content Modeling Client Discovery Requirements Extraction Scope Definition A/B Testing Stakeholder Management Code Review Git GitHub GitLab Jira Wrike

EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Developer

Jan 2024 – Present

Miles Partnership · Remote

- Serve as lead accessibility developer — conducting AQA testing, authoring accessibility tasks, and reviewing PRs across the development team to uphold WCAG standards.
- Founded and drove the company's Core Web Vitals initiative, now embedded in contracts with multiple clients; authored all internal CWV documentation and own ongoing task creation and code review for the program.
- Architect and build new features and components across a portfolio of up to 65 clients, contributing deep JavaScript logic, UI implementation, and system-level architecture decisions.

- Triage and resolve bugs at scale, maintaining performance and stability across a large, multi-client codebase.

Freelance Development Consultant

Jun 2022 – Jan 2024

Independent · Austin, TX

- Lead customer discovery conversations to surface business goals, uncover technical constraints, and extract precise requirements before scoping new development initiatives.
- Advise on high-impact improvements to existing designs, workflows, and site architecture based on structured requirements extraction and stakeholder input.
- Coordinate tasks and project deliverables with client teams including designers and content creators.
- Design and build responsive, accessible websites optimized to drive business goals and user engagement.

Frontend Engineer

Dec 2021 – Jun 2022

IfThen · Remote

- Collaborated with backend developers to define and consume well-structured API contracts on the frontend.
- Built component libraries and global style guides aligned to client brand identities, packaged and distributed via NPM for multi-site use.
- Managed stakeholder relationships across client sales, marketing, and engineering teams to align on requirements and deliver scalable, intuitive site architectures and navigation systems.
- Architected React file structures and tooling for deployment in SPAs and static site integrations.

Senior Frontend Developer → Frontend Engineer

Apr 2020 – Nov 2021

Forum One · Remote

- Served as technical lead and primary stakeholder contact on small-to-medium projects — managing client relationships, extracting requirements, and owning delivery from architecture through launch.
- Conducted requirements extraction sessions with clients and managers to design scalable information architectures and detailed content models for components, page types, and site sections.
- Collaborated with design and UX teams to validate technical feasibility of UI/UX designs and translate wireframes into interactive components.
- Built reusable component libraries across multiple frameworks; optimized applications for performance and accessibility (WCAG compliance).
- Mentored junior and associate developers through code reviews, technical instruction, and hands-on training.

Senior Frontend Developer → Project Manager

Apr 2016 – Mar 2020

Mediacurrent · Remote

- Built and maintained custom themes across multiple platforms and technology stacks including Drupal, WordPress, React, and Angular.
- Led a team of developers — setting priorities, assigning tasks, providing ticket estimates, and defining acceptance criteria.
- Acted as liaison between project stakeholders, the project manager, and the development team to align technical delivery with business goals.
- Promoted to Project Manager — facilitated cross-functional meetings and planning activities for a globally distributed technology team across multiple time zones.
- Led stakeholder management across executive, technical, and client-facing teams — defining project responsibilities, acceptance criteria, and documentation standards.
- Managed project scope, timeline, and budget allocation for major feature builds while proactively resolving blockers to ensure on-time delivery.

EDUCATION

A.A.S. in Computer and Information Sciences — May 2012

Dutchess Community College — New York

Studies in Public Relations, Advertising & Applied Communication — 1999 – 2002

The University of Texas at San Antonio